RWANDA AGRIBIOTECH PROGRAMME

The Role of Risk in the Approval Framework and Communication of Biotech Crops

Workshop Report



Kigali June 16-17, 2026

Day 1 Meeting Minutes: Technical Foundations, Risk Analysis, Product Stewardship and Practical Dossier content

Meeting Title: The Role of Risk in the Approval Framework and Communication of Biotech Crops

Date: 16 June 2026 | **Location:** Kigali, Rwanda | **Format:** Hybrid meeting with in-person and online participants

Purpose: To build a shared technical foundation on risk analysis, biosafety approval, product stewardship, variety registration and practical communication of biotech crop products advancing toward registration, seed multiplication and responsible deployment in Rwanda.

08:00 – 09:00 | Arrival and Registration

Participants arrived, registered and joined the workshop physically and online. The organizing team coordinated virtual participation, confirmed readiness of presentation materials and allowed a few minutes for participants to settle before the formal opening. The hybrid set-up enabled remote participants, to follow the proceedings and contribute where required.

09:00 – 09:30 | Opening Remarks and Introductions



In the formal opening remarks, the Acting Director General of RAB, Dr Florence Uwamahoro welcomed participants to Kigali and thanked AATF, MSU, government institutions, development partners, experts and organizers for supporting the workshop. The remarks noted that Rwanda's agriculture faces persistent challenges including climate change, pests, diseases, productivity constraints and market demands, and that biotechnology offers opportunities only when introduced responsibly, safely and with clear public understanding. The opening highlighted that cassava, potato and maize products are approaching important registration and deployment milestones, making it necessary to prepare both regulatory systems and communication systems. Participants were encouraged to engage actively, ask difficult questions, share practical experience and identify solutions that will support science-based decision making, responsible stewardship and evidence-based communication to farmers, consumers, policymakers and the wider public.



Athanase opened the session by welcoming participants and inviting introductions by institutions. He highlighted that the workshop has brought together representatives from AATF, RAB, CIP, MSU, DDPSC, Rwanda Media Commission, biosafety and seed regulatory institutions, research stations, seed sector actors, farmer representatives, media, communicators, legal and policy stakeholders. The introductions emphasized that the workshop was intentionally multidisciplinary, bringing together scientists, regulators, communicators, seed actors and users who will be involved in product deployment and public engagement.

09:30 – 10:00 | Risk Analysis in Decision Making by Rob



The session introduced risk analysis as the structured process used to make decisions about something new. Rob explained that the process begins by defining the current baseline, identifying the change being introduced, considering whether the change could create harm or increase an existing harm, assessing the likelihood of exposure, and determining whether any identified risk can be managed. Participants were reminded that risk analysis is not only a scientific exercise but a decision-support process.

Three linked elements were emphasized: risk assessment, risk management and risk communication. Risk assessment was described as a science-based review of hazards, potential consequences and likelihood of exposure. Risk management was described as the process of reducing harm or reducing exposure, using examples such as insulated electrical wires and circuit breakers. Risk communication was presented as the process of explaining how decisions are made, what evidence was considered, and what practical management actions are needed after approval.

A major message from the session was that safety should be communicated comparatively. Participants discussed that no product can be proven absolutely risk-free; rather, the relevant question is whether the biotech product is "as safe as" its conventional counterpart and whether it introduces any new or increased risk. Rob who facilitated the sessions also distinguished risk assessment from risk-benefit decision making, noting that socioeconomic, trade and adoption considerations may be relevant when authorities decide whether and how to approve or manage a product.

During discussion, participants emphasized that communication must be audience-specific. Messages for technical reviewers, decision makers, industry actors, farmers, consumers and the general public should not be identical. Participants noted that communicators should not try to turn everyone into scientists, but should translate the evidence into practical, understandable explanations. Informal communication was also highlighted, since workshop participants may be asked by family members, neighbors, customers or journalists to explain what biotech products are and why they are being considered.

10:00 – 10:30 | Group Photograph and Networking Coffee Break

A group photograph was taken following the opening session. Participants then proceeded to a networking coffee break, which provided an opportunity for informal exchanges among workshop participants, facilitators, and invited stakeholders.

10:30 – 10:45 | Biotech Products Overview by Athanase

The product overview session presented Rwanda's biotech crop pipeline and the rationale for priority products. The discussion covered cassava, potato, maize and future work on banana. Key production challenges included cassava brown streak disease, potato late blight, fall armyworm in maize and disease challenges in banana. The presenter explained that biotechnology is being used to complement conventional improvement where existing approaches have not adequately solved major production constraints.

For cassava, participants were informed that resistance to cassava brown streak virus is based on RNA interference, which helps to disrupt virus recognition of the plant as a host. The session recalled the severe

impact of cassava brown streak disease on production and root quality in previous outbreaks. For potato, late blight-resistant lines based on resistance genes from wild potato relatives were presented, including work on Victoria and Shangi as well as other varieties. For maize, Bt technology was discussed as a tool to protect against fall armyworm. Athanase also noted that genome editing work is emerging, particularly for future banana and other crop products.

Trial results and product performance were summarized. Cassava lines under evaluation showed strong resistance and encouraging performance compared with conventional checks, while consumer acceptance work examined willingness to grow, buy and use the products. Potato trials had been conducted over multiple seasons, with resistant lines showing strong performance against late blight and sensory qualities comparable to conventional potatoes. Maize results were still preliminary but indicated promising resistance and yield performance. Participants discussed the need to communicate both the safety evidence and the practical benefits to farmers and consumers, including reduced losses, better quality produce and more reliable production.

A question was raised on how genome editing and transgenic technologies may be treated by regulatory bodies and how such distinctions should be communicated. The response clarified that biosafety authorities focus on safety-related issues, while other institutions are involved in variety registration, seed certification and commercialization. Genome editing guidelines for Rwanda were still being developed, and participants noted the importance of communicating such technologies clearly and accurately to farmers, consumers, policymakers and other stakeholders.

10:45 – 11:30 | continuation of; Risk Assessment of Biotech Products by Rob

This session explained the data package used to assess biotech products before environmental release and commercialization. Rob underlined that risk assessment of genetically engineered or transgenic plants is not new; more than three decades of experience have generated accepted approaches for evaluating product safety. The process begins with the biology and agronomy of the conventional crop as the baseline, then assesses what has changed and whether the change creates any new or increased risk.

The assessment process reviewed the transformation method, molecular characterization, stability of the inserted DNA, protein expression, nutritional composition, agronomic performance and environmental effects. Molecular characterization confirms the inserted DNA, verifies that the event is stable across generations, and examines flanking sequences to check whether unintended proteins could be produced.

Protein safety was explained using a weight-of-evidence approach. The assessment considers the source organism, similarity to known toxins or allergens, digestibility, heat stability and, only where justified, further toxicity or allergenicity testing. For cassava, the resistance mechanism does not lead to production of a new viral protein. For potato, the resistance proteins are similar to naturally occurring plant resistance proteins. For maize, the Bt protein has a long history of safe use and is specific to target insects.

Rob also discussed confined field trials as a way to generate agronomic, phenotypic and compositional data while controlling exposure before full environmental release. Participants were reminded that standard operating procedures, isolation requirements, field sanitation, trial records and documentation are essential because they show how spread was prevented and how product performance was assessed. Agronomic and nutritional comparisons were made against conventional counterparts using replicated trials and relevant crop-specific measures.

The session reported that relevant data had been reviewed by Rwanda's competent authority, REMA, and that the products were found to present no new or increased risks for environmental release or for human and

animal consumption when compared with conventional counterparts. However, participants were reminded that approval is not the end of the process. Stewardship remains necessary to preserve product value, maintain seed quality, monitor resistance and ensure responsible deployment.

11:30 – 12:00 | Risk Management: Stewardship of Biotech Plants by Francis

The stewardship session built on the risk assessment discussion by asking why risk management is still needed when products have been assessed as presenting no new or increased safety risk. Participants identified human error, product handling, implementation challenges and the need to maintain trust as reasons for continued management. The presenter explained that stewardship goes beyond risk control: it covers product integrity, quality assurance, traceability, regulatory compliance, resistance management, responsible use and product value across the full life cycle.

Stewardship was framed around five principles: regular assessment, stakeholder engagement, regulatory compliance, sustainability and social responsibility. Francis used the comparison of regulation as obtaining a driver's licence and stewardship as responsible driving after obtaining the licence. In this sense, regulatory approval confirms that basic safety requirements have been met, while stewardship ensures responsible and sustainable use throughout seed production, marketing, distribution and farmer adoption.

Key stewardship tools discussed included standard operating procedures, quality management systems, record keeping, licensing and technology agreements, product labelling, farmer training, monitoring, audits, compliance reporting, resistance management and mechanisms to prevent unauthorized movement of seed beyond approved geographies. The presenter emphasized that Rwanda should align stewardship implementation with international best practices, including Excellence Through Stewardship principles, while adapting practices to local seed systems and smallholder realities.

12:00 – 12:30 | Biotech Products Stewardship Plans by Immaculate

The session presented crop-specific stewardship plans developed during earlier technical consultations. The plans were designed to guide responsible commercialization and deployment of biotech cassava, maize and potato products in Rwanda. Immaculate explained that the plans were built by identifying biological and environmental risks, mapping regulatory requirements, defining stakeholders and roles, designing seed production and handling protocols, identifying training needs and preparing for implementation and review.

The plans cover product life cycle management, seed quality standards, post-release monitoring, incident response, licensing, regulatory reporting, compliance with national biosafety and seed requirements, and responsibilities across the seed delivery chain. Cassava and potato were described as vegetatively propagated crops with low gene flow risk, while maize requires more intensive management because it is a hybrid seed crop with pollen movement and insect resistance management considerations.

Specific stewardship measures discussed included diagnostic testing, seed class management, greenhouse and field production standards, refuge requirements for maize, isolation measures, sentinel plots, product identity preservation, QR code-based traceability, batch records, labelling, farmer hotlines, point-of-sale documentation, farmer contact records and mass-balance reconciliation between seed produced and seed distributed. Participants also discussed the need for farmer-friendly approaches, noting that traceability requirements should be adapted for smallholder farmers through extension support, telephone contacts, district and village location details, and practical field-level documentation.

Post-market environmental monitoring was explained through two pillars: case-specific monitoring and general surveillance. Case-specific monitoring focuses on trait durability, resistance development, pathogen or insect

populations, and product performance. General surveillance focuses on broader environmental indicators such as non-target organisms, weediness, soil health and unexpected effects. The plans also include incident response steps: notification, verification, convening an incident response team, mitigation, regulatory reporting, corrective action, updated training and continuous improvement. Transboundary movement controls were also discussed, including licensing terms, packaging controls, customs and border awareness, movement records and community sensitization in border districts.

12:30 – 13:00 | Variety Registration Dossiers by Athanase

The variety registration session explained Rwanda's conventional procedure for registering crop varieties, including biotech-derived varieties after biosafety approval. The process requires submission of a variety registration application, supporting data and documentation for each variety. Requirements discussed included national performance trial data across seasons and agroecological zones, distinctness, uniformity and stability information, breeder or owner consent where applicable, environmental release approval for biotech products, and review by the plant variety release committee before official notification and getting.

Participants were informed that the products are progressing through registration steps and that positive feedback had been received for some submissions, with official notification expected from the competent authority. The objective is to align product registration and seed availability with upcoming planting seasons, including demonstration activities, seed multiplication, private-sector engagement and post-release stewardship monitoring. Communication expectations included keeping authorities informed, clarifying variety names and traits, communicating availability timelines, documenting trial and validation results, and preparing stewardship and monitoring materials for deployment.

13:00 – 14:00 | Networking Luncheon

The lunch break was used for networking and informal discussion. Participants were advised to reconvene for the afternoon breakout session. Online participants were informed of the schedule, and some indicated they would rejoin for Day 2 sessions.

14:00 – 16:00 | Group Breakout Discussions: How to Answer Risk Assessment Questions

The afternoon session translated the technical risk assessment presentations into practical exercises. Participants were divided into working groups and asked to review a standard application form for intentional introduction or environmental release of a living modified organism. The purpose was not to train all participants to become dossier writers, but to help them understand the type of information that goes into regulatory decision making and to build confidence in explaining the evidence behind product approval.

Rob who facilitated the session explained that the application form contains technical questions on product identity, genetic modification, donor organisms, transformation methods, molecular characterization, protein expression, phenotypic characteristics, field trial data, receiving environments, previous approvals, risk assessment summaries and risk management plans. Participants were guided to identify which study reports or data sources would provide answers to each section, including biology documents, molecular characterization, gene expression studies, bioinformatics, protein safety, agronomic and phenotypic trials, nutritional composition, environmental interaction studies and stewardship plans.

The group discussion emphasized that not all data must be generated locally; some information, such as crop biology and molecular characterization data, can be drawn from internationally accepted references or previous product dossiers, while local trials confirm performance and relevance under Rwanda's conditions. Participants also discussed practical communication questions likely to arise from farmers, customers, regulators,

policymakers and the public, such as: Is the product safe? What was changed? Where did the gene come from? How do you know the product works? How do you monitor it after release? What happens if resistance develops?

During the practical review, participants discussed the importance of answering regulatory questions precisely without overloading a dossier with irrelevant information. They reviewed examples related to cassava brown streak virus resistance, including product identity, event designation, intellectual property ownership, category of modification, Agrobacterium-mediated transformation, selection methods, molecular characterization, PCR-based detection, protein expression, bioinformatics and risk assessment language. The session reinforced the use of careful wording such as "negligible risk," "no evidence of new or increased risk," and "not likely to occur," rather than absolute claims.

16:00 – 16:30 | Recap of Day One

The recap consolidated the main messages of the day. Participants had examined how risk analysis supports decision making, why safety must be communicated comparatively, what data were reviewed for cassava, potato and maize products, how stewardship supports responsible deployment, how variety registration proceeds after biosafety approval, and how technical evidence can be translated into practical questions and answers for non-technical audiences. The day closed with agreement that communication should be evidence-based, audience-specific and linked to concrete farmer and consumer benefits.

Day 2 Meeting Minutes: Communication Protocols, Digital Advocacy and Action Planning

Date: 17 June 2026 | **Location:** Kigali, Rwanda | **Format:** Hybrid meeting with in-person and online participants

Purpose: To strengthen participants' capacity to communicate biotech crop risk, safety, stewardship and product benefits in a clear, credible, audience-specific and coordinated manner, while supporting Rwanda's communication protocols and stakeholder engagement plans.

08:00 – 09:00 | Arrival and Registration

Participants arrived, registered and rejoined the workshop physically and online. The organizing team coordinated hybrid participation and addressed connectivity, screen-sharing and audio issues to enable online presenters and participants to follow the proceedings.

09:00 – 09:30 | Overview of Day Two and Reflection on Day One

Day 2 opened with reflections on the Day 1 practical risk assessment exercise. Participants noted that regulatory risk assessment was useful for decision making and the information was useful during public communication. Rob emphasized that the exercise demonstrated a key lesson: technical risk assessment language is precise and necessary for regulators, but it must be translated into simpler questions and answers for farmers, consumers, media and non-specialist audiences.

The discussion created a bridge into Day 2, which focused on communication approaches, protocols, tools, social media, active listening and practical conversations.

09:30 – 10:30 | Biotech Communication: General Approach and Overview

Nancy Muchiri presented the general approach to biotech communication. She defined biotech communication as the strategic use of communication to support biotech innovations to achieve impact. She emphasized that

communication is not merely visibility or awareness creation; it is a bridge between scientific innovation and real human needs. It connects evidence with values, possibility with trust, and science with people.

The session highlighted that biotech communicators operate in an environment shaped by regulated technologies, novelty, complexity, suspicion, perceived risk and uncertainty. Participants were reminded that scientific facts do not automatically become public truth, especially in an emotion-driven and attention-engineered information environment. The presenter referred to shifts from "post-truth" to online engagements, noting that communication must respond to the realities of misinformation, distrust and algorithm-driven visibility.

A key message was that science remains respected, but acceptance depends on trust, relevance, engagement and legitimacy. The presenter emphasized a shift from one-way communication to two-way dialogue; from facts and data to relevance and real-life value; from experts alone as messengers to trusted community voices; from persuasion to shared ownership; and from information delivery to trust building. Participants were encouraged to ask "so what?" when developing messages, ensuring that technical claims are translated into meaning for farmers, consumers and decision makers.

The presentation outlined the importance of preparation, audience mapping, issue identification, message consistency and integration of communication across the product development life cycle. Communication was described as a capability that accompanies innovation from research and development through field testing, approval, commercialization, adoption and post-market activities. The presenter summarized biotech communication as "enabling impact, safeguarding investment and delivering benefit."

During discussion, participants raised the challenge of translating technical safety language into public messages. The phrase "no increased risk" was discussed as scientifically accurate but potentially confusing for public audiences. It was agreed that public communication should not overstate or misrepresent evidence, but should use clearer language such as explaining that the product has been assessed and is as safe as comparable food already consumed. Participants also emphasized that if a serious post-approval issue were ever identified, transparency, regulatory reporting and corrective action would protect credibility.

Another discussion point concerned mental models, including perceptions of foreign control, dependency, seed ownership and historical mistrust. Participants noted that technical evidence alone may not persuade audiences holding such concerns. Communication should therefore address underlying narratives and values, not only scientific facts. Participants also called for a shared Kinyarwanda vocabulary for biotechnology terms to improve consistency, clarity and cultural relevance in local-language communication.

10:30 – 11:00 | Communication Protocol

The communication protocol session presented the need for coordinated credible and consistent communication across partners. The protocol was described as a decision-support and governance framework that clarifies who communicates, through which channels, and under what approval process. It is intended to prevent mixed messages, protect institutional reputation and maintain public trust.

The session identified priority audiences including policymakers, regulators, farmers, consumers, media, donors, private-sector actors, community leaders, extension staff and technical specialists. A power-interest matrix was introduced as a tool for classifying stakeholders and determining the appropriate level of engagement. Participants discussed that stakeholder categories may shift depending on whether the objective is project management, public communication, policy engagement or farmer adoption.

The presenter emphasized the need for a unified voice, especially for formal public statements, regulatory milestones, media responses and crisis situations. RAB was recognized as the primary national authority and lead source of verified public information on agriculture and crop biotechnology in Rwanda, with partners supporting through coordinated communication, amplification and technical expertise.

The session also provided practical media engagement guidance. Participants were advised to be prepared, identify key messages before interviews, avoid guessing, acknowledge what they do not know, follow up with verified information, use human stories and local examples, and remain respectful while keeping control of the message. The "acknowledge, bridge and return to key messages" technique was demonstrated using a difficult media question on whether biotech crops are poisonous. Participants noted that interviewees are not required to answer misleading questions word-for-word; they should stay factual while redirecting to accurate, approved messages.

The session also addressed appearance and presentation for media engagements. Participants were reminded that visual impressions affect audience perception, and that spokespersons should dress appropriately for the programme context, avoid distracting accessories, prepare for lighting and cameras, and maintain a professional image when representing the programme.

11:00 – 11:30 | Mid-Morning Coffee Break and Networking

Participants took a short networking break. Online participants remained connected while the organizing team managed audio and reconnection issues before the next sessions.

11:30 – 12:00 | Communication Resources and Tools

George presented the communication resources developed to support stakeholder engagement in Rwanda. The tools included frequently asked question booklets in English and Kinyarwanda, core messages, an issue management and critical response guide, a project brief, communication approach guidance, branding and visual identity templates, policy briefs, the project website, newsletters, press releases and social media materials.

Participants were encouraged to familiarize themselves with these resources and use them to provide accurate and consistent information during engagements with farmers, media, donors, partners and other stakeholders. The FAQ booklets were highlighted as practical tools for answering common questions, while core messages were described as a "message bible" for maintaining consistency across speakers and institutions.

The presenter noted that some tools are finalized and already shared, while others remain under development, including pocket messages and additional policy briefs for cassava and maize. Participants were encouraged to contribute content for newsletters and project updates, and to use approved branding templates for presentations and communication products.

12:00 – 12:30 | Social Media and Rwanda Crop Biotechnology Communication Strategy

Pacifique presented the Rwanda crop biotechnology communication strategy and the role of social media. The session emphasized that scientific evidence alone does not guarantee adoption, because most people do not read scientific publications. Communication must therefore translate verified evidence into accessible, trusted and locally relevant messages for ordinary citizens.

The presenter explained that biotechnology touches food, farming, family health, regulation, business and trust. For that reason, communication must reach farmers, consumers, policymakers, regulators, media and other actors using channels that fit their realities. Formal institutional platforms such as RAB websites, press releases,

regulatory notices and scientific publications are important but may not reach the public directly. Social media, radio, drama and trusted community voices can help translate formal content into practical messages.

Participants discussed using trained digital champions, young farmers, journalists, social media influencers and farmer networks to amplify verified messages. Demonstrations and field visits were highlighted as powerful because "seeing is believing." The strategy also includes radio and entertainment formats, including drama-based approaches, to reach rural audiences who may not regularly use smartphones or social media.

Key message themes included presenting biotechnology first as a tool to solve agricultural challenges, such as late blight, fall armyworm and cassava brown streak disease; explaining expected benefits for farmers, consumers and food systems; and ensuring transparency, scientific accuracy and institutional credibility. Participants discussed the importance of product-specific messaging, for example saying "we are eating potato, cassava or maize," rather than focusing only on abstract technology.

Several practical examples were discussed to make biotechnology relatable, including crop improvement over time, hybrid maize adoption, imported tomato seed, naturally occurring genetic changes in common foods, and the difference between insect digestive systems and human digestion in explaining Bt specificity. Participants noted that these examples can help answer difficult questions in plain language while remaining scientifically accurate.

Discussion also covered division of communication roles among RAB, AATF, OFAB, project partners and technical institutions. It was clarified that RAB should coordinate formal national communication on regulatory milestones and official announcements, while partners may run campaigns or support issue clarification within their areas of expertise, provided messages remain coordinated and aligned.

12:30 – 13:30 | Networking Luncheon

The morning session closed with appreciation to the presenters. Participants proceeded to lunch and were informed that the afternoon session would resume with practical breakout activities on active listening and meaningful conversations.

13:30 – 15:00 | Breakout Communications Activity: Active Listening and Meaningful Conversations



The afternoon session focused on communication practice. The active listening exercise aimed to help participants listen with the intent to understand rather than prepare an immediate response. Participants worked in pairs, with one person acting as speaker and the other as listener. The speaker described an image while the listener drew it without seeing the original. The exercise demonstrated the importance of clarity, sequence, precision, feedback, patience and shared language in communication.

Participants were encouraged to conduct the exercise in the language in which they were most comfortable. During the plenary reflection, the facilitator explained that effective communication often requires breaking

complex ideas into smaller parts, using clear descriptions and confirming understanding. This was linked to biotech communication, where technical concepts must be translated step by step for non-specialist audiences.

The meaningful conversations activity asked participants to select a crop—cassava, maize or potato—and use the FAQ materials to answer questions in their own words. Participants role-played conversations with non-technical audiences such as a parent, neighbor, teacher, farmer or general public member. The activity reinforced the need to explain risk assessment, stewardship, safety and benefits in simple, relatable language while remaining transparent, consistent and aligned with project messages.

The facilitator reminded participants that communication is a skill that improves with practice. Participants were encouraged to become advocates who can confidently explain the products and available resources, and to multiply impact by engaging people within their own networks.

15:00 – 15:30 | Group Discussions and Presentation of Group Work

Groups reflected on the active listening and meaningful conversations exercises. Participants generally found the activities useful and engaging. Some reported that rephrasing technical FAQ answers into natural language was easier than expected, while others found it challenging. The discussion reinforced that communication requires practice, preparation and familiarity with approved resources.

Participants appreciated that the workshop brought together people directly involved in the work, including those not always in front-facing communication roles. It was noted that the workshop helped build a common understanding among technical, regulatory, communication and partner teams, reinforcing the idea that everyone has a role in responsible biotech communication.

15:30 – 16:00 | Overview of Pending and Upcoming Communication Materials

The communication team noted that additional materials remain under preparation, including pocket messages, policy briefs, communication strategy refinements, issue-response materials, social media products, newsletter content and video testimonials. Participants were informed that short video recordings would be captured from selected technical team members and session managers to document key takeaways and support future communication products.

Closing Remarks

The closing session appreciated participants for their time, active engagement and commitment throughout the two-day workshop. Dr Athanase thanked facilitators, presenters, technical experts, communication teams, partners and participants who travelled to Kigali and those who joined online. The closing remarks recognized that the programme is now seeing concrete results from long-term partnership and investment, and encouraged participants to continue working together as champions of responsible communication and product stewardship. The workshop officially closed with a call for continued collaboration, ongoing communication among partners and application of the knowledge, tools and techniques gained during the sessions.

Potential Areas for Improvement for Future Workshops

Participants and facilitators identified several areas for future workshops. These included allocating more time for group discussions and feedback, improving time management across sessions, strengthening hybrid audio and screen-sharing arrangements, preparing simplified question-and-answer materials in advance, developing a common Kinyarwanda biotechnology lexicon, and continuing practical media and conversation exercises. It was also suggested that future training includes additional role-play on difficult media questions and more product-specific examples that participants can use in real-life conversations.


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